Connect Graphify

Give your helper a map of a codebase, so it reads less and understands more.

Kind Walkthrough | Changed 2026-11-04 | For Teams sharing a codebase with helpers

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TL;DR

1. **Graphify builds a map of a codebase:** what each part does, what connects to what, and the few central pieces everything leans on.
2. Your helper reads the map first, so it understands a project quickly and reads far fewer files.
3. **For a team, this is shared memory.** Every helper and every person starts from the same picture.

> ***Handing this to your AI helper?*** *Say: "Read CONNECT-GRAPHIFY.md. Is there a `graphify-out/` folder here? If so, read its GRAPH_REPORT.md before anything else."*

Using a map that already exists

If a repository has `graphify-out/GRAPH_REPORT.md`, your helper should read it **before** searching the code. Ask it questions in plain words:

- *"Using the graph, how does the language switch reach the Spanish text?"*
- *"What are the central pieces of this site, and what depends on them?"*

The interactive picture, `graphify-out/graph.html`, opens in any browser.

Making or refreshing a map

This is for whoever looks after the machinery.

```
# once per computer (the package name has a double y)
uv tool install graphifyy --with anthropic --with openai

# in the repository
graphify extract .          # builds the graph
graphify cluster-only .     # writes GRAPH_REPORT.md (no AI calls)
graphify claude install     # Claude Code reads the report before it searches
```

- **Keep it focused:** add a `.graphifyignore`. The base template lives in this repository's root; add the project's private folders to it so research and notes never enter the map.
- **Keep it private:**
  - `graphify-out/` lives in the **private** workshop repository.
  - A website's tripwire stops it from ever being published.

    - `manifest.json` and `cost.json` stay out of git.
- **After big changes:** `graphify update .` refreshes the map from the code itself, with no AI cost.

Why it matters for an organization

When several people and several AI helpers share a project, the hardest thing is shared understanding. A graph gives everyone the same map:

- **New contributors:** start oriented.
- **Helpers:** spend their effort on the change, not on rediscovering the project.
- **The future help desk:** has a reliable map to answer from.

The full evaluation, including the security review: GRAPHIFY_SETUP.md.

Suggest a change

Noticed something wrong, or know a better way? Open an issue or a pull request against `main`; the lab steward reads them, and a person with the role merges with a merge commit so your name stays on it. Not on GitHub? Tell any steward you know, or your helper, in your own words.

One of the walkthroughs in `my-template`. Icons: Lucide (ISC).